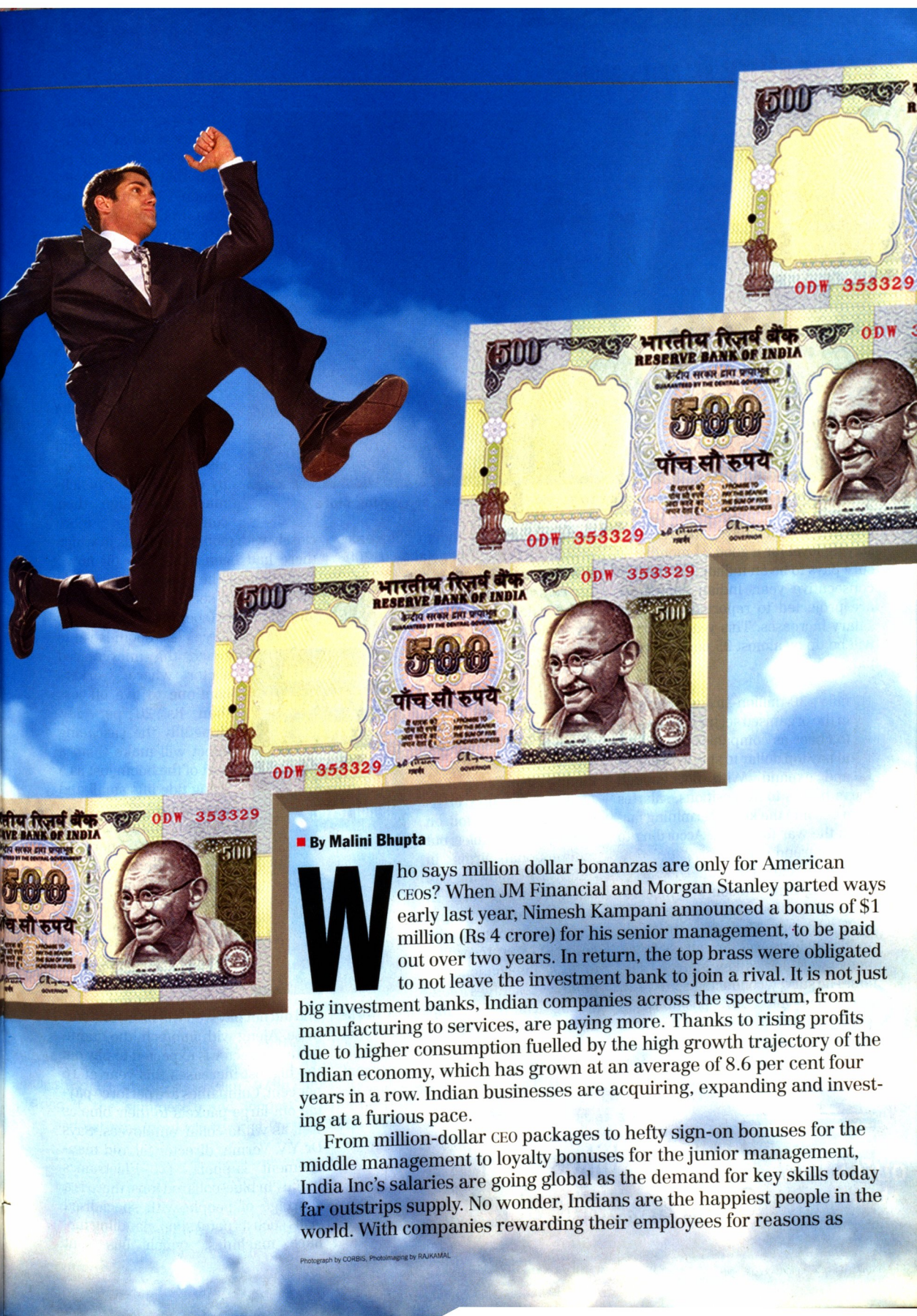




■ By Malini Bhupta

Who says million dollar bonanzas are only for American CEOs? When JM Financial and Morgan Stanley parted ways early last year, Nimesh Kampani announced a bonus of \$1 million (Rs 4 crore) for his senior management, to be paid out over two years. In return, the top brass were obligated to not leave the investment bank to join a rival. It is not just big investment banks, Indian companies across the spectrum, from manufacturing to services, are paying more. Thanks to rising profits due to higher consumption fuelled by the high growth trajectory of the Indian economy, which has grown at an average of 8.6 per cent four years in a row. Indian businesses are acquiring, expanding and investing at a furious pace.

From million-dollar CEO packages to hefty sign-on bonuses for the middle management to loyalty bonuses for the junior management, India Inc's salaries are going global as the demand for key skills today far outstrips supply. No wonder, Indians are the happiest people in the world. With companies rewarding their employees for reasons as

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